



Counting Happiness

BSG Statistics Department Monthly Newsletter



MOUNT FUJI

The Spirit of Statistics Incharges



VALIANT STATISTICS INCHARGES — STANDING TALL LIKE MOUNT FUJI IN FAITH AND UNITY

Dear Mathematicians of Happiness-
Valiant Statistics Incharges of BSG,

We extend our deepest appreciation to each one of you for all your painstaking efforts in maintaining the BDS and taking care of each life on behalf of our beloved mentor Ikeda Sensei. Month after month, it fills us with immense joy to hear your inspiring reports of progress - proof that we are growing stronger and brighter as we advance towards **2030**.

Ikeda Sensei writes, **"Sharing Nichiren Buddhsim is a noble undertaking in which we show utmost respect for each person and sincerely encourage them.... With even a single word, we can plant the seed of Buddhahood in another person's life. Such a seed, once planted, will someday definitely sprout, blossom, and bear fruit"** (Humanology of Victory, p. 87).

This guidance is a clarion call from our mentor. It reminds us to persevere in holding dialogues, doing shakubuku, and encouraging, supporting, and uplifting our comrades in faith with the spirit of **"cherishing each life"**. This is not merely a slogan; it is the essence of the **Soka spirit**, the way of life of each Bodhisattva of the Earth.

Like the majestic **Mount Fuji**, which stands firm and unshaken through every storm, our mission too calls for unwavering resolve and quiet strength. No matter how steep the climb, we rise step by step, together - confident that our united efforts will one day illuminate the summit with victory. Each sincere action - every dialogue, every update, every encouraging word - adds to the mountain of hope and happiness we are building across India.

To further support your efforts, new features such as the **Friends Ageing Report** and the simplified process for **adding the new introductions into the BDS** (*read the Sept 2025 issue of ABACUS*) has been introduced. You can read about the **Friends Ageing Report** in this issue of ABACUS under BDS section. We truly hope that these new updates help you treasure our cherished friends and members even more deeply.

As we advance towards November 18th, let us joyfully renew our vow to advance shakubuku and member care in unity and victory.

With our best regards
- **By ABACUS Editorial Team** ★★

ENCOURAGING ONE ANOTHER AND ADVANCING TOGETHER

Start by Listening

The key to dialogue is listening. Listening is learning; it expands our world. If we interact with others with respect and sincerity, dialogue will naturally flow. Dialogue is the way to achieve real heart-to-heart communication.

An ancient philosopher said the reason we have two ears is so we may listen twice as much as we speak.

Sometimes just having someone to listen can dispel your worries and concerns. Or when you share a problem with someone, the answer may become clear as you talk about it.

Dialogue has the wondrous power to elevate its participants to a new and higher plane—that's why listening intently to someone is in itself a great form of encouragement.



Praising Others' Efforts

Showing all who dedicate themselves to kosen-rufu the same respect one would a Buddha—this is the foremost message of the Lotus Sutra (cf. OTT: SG 192; EG 295). When we praise those striving for kosen-rufu, we gain benefit ourselves and help others do the same.

As Nichiren Daishonin writes: “When praised highly by others, one feels that there is no hardship one cannot bear. Such is the courage that springs from words of praise” (‘The True Aspect of All Phenomena’, WND-1, 385).

As leaders, it is important not to overlook those who are working hard behind the scenes. Be keenly aware of even the smallest positive efforts they are making and praise them. Impart hope and motivation.

I hope you will help draw forth each person's unique qualities and work

together with everyone in a spirit of mutual respect. Such teamwork will lead to solid development.

(Humanology of Victory, p. 70-71)



Chant, strive, and win together!

When someone is struggling, read the Goshō with them, chant to the Gohonzon with them, and take a step forward together with them. Empathizing with the struggles of others and chanting daimoku with them will also give you the strength to overcome your own problems. Those who encourage one another will flourish and triumph together.

Referring to the way plants coexist harmoniously in nature, the Daishonin writes: “Even insentient plants and trees share as one a friend’s joys and sorrows” (WND-2, 964).

When we encounter especially difficult obstacles, let’s encourage one another even more cheerfully and positively. In precisely such trying times, let’s courageously take on each challenge, uniting to overcome them one by one. That is our role as fellow members in faith and the purpose of our Buddhist practice.

(VC, Feb 2015, p. 60) ★★

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

“With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu.”



ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

“A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today.”

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)



DISCOVERING THE HEART OF STATISTICS: EVERY NUMBER HOLDS A NOBLE LIFE

Beena Pandey

***Chapter Statistics Incharge
South Delhi Area***

I started practising and joined the wonderful world of Soka in the year 2005. Since then, my life has undergone major transformation as I based everything on faith. I became more hopeful and optimistic amidst challenges in daily life. In the year 2015 I got the responsibility of



Scan to listen to
the experience

taking care of statistics. When this opportunity came, I was initially hesitant due to my fear of handling statistics. However, I took it as a challenge inspired by Sensei's words: **"Kosen-rufu is a continuous effort to pioneer the unexplored frontier. It is a task arduous beyond belief."**

We can never expect it to be easy.... Let's throw ourselves into sincerely and wholeheartedly supporting each and every member. That's the way of a champion" (*Guidelines for Kosen-rufu, Victory, and Happiness*, p. 84). As I began, I realized that my role went beyond just taking care of statistics as numbers. Encouraged by Sensei's guidance I discovered that all my members are indeed "Noble Treasure Towers". This shifted my perspective that each member's information on BDS represents a unique life with a pulsating spirit. I believed that it is my responsibility and mission now to cherish each person to the utmost. At present I am supporting as a dual statistics incharge for chapter and one of the districts.

I started chanting regularly to build my confidence and eventually grew to enjoy the entire process of taking care of statistics. Through this role, I could connect with many members not only in my unit but also across BSG, including fellow statistics incharges. I've also had the opportunity to reconnect inactive members, like one YMD who had shifted from Delhi to Northeast area after being inactive for 8-10 years. Handling this responsibility has polished every aspect of my life. I'm

passionate about introducing new lives to faith and nurturing their spiritual growth. Whenever I initiate a member transfer, I ensure a seamless transition by connecting with the respective statistics incharge, guaranteeing they feel supported in their new district.

I am diligent about marking attendance promptly after meetings and actively participate in planning home visits and member care with fellow division leaders. This year I've been fortunate to make one shakubuku so far (YMD) and I am constantly keeping in touch with him to help him connect well with Sensei and the practice, and I'm praying for many more to emerge in my environment. I also coordinate with other district statistics incharges in my chapter and based on my own experience, encourage them to cherish each life. I often get in touch with friends in the (BDS) to encourage them to come for the meetings.

With my continued efforts in faith and statistics, I am determined and confident to achieve multiple victories in my life and report them to Ikeda Sensei. I resolve to strengthen my faith, practice, and study daily. I further determine to strengthen my vow and fulfill it for eternity. ★★

Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the **'Discussion Meeting'** attendance in the month of September 2025.

We accord these zones as **'MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH'** for September 2025.

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi - East

- Expressway – Jaypee
- Ghaziabad
- Greno West
- Indirapuram
- Noida – Vasundhara
- Noida City Centre
- Noida West
- Sahibabad – Meerut
- Shahdara – Anand Vihar

East India

- Behala – Joka
- Central Kolkata
- Dumdum
- Howrah
- Odisha North 1
- Odisha North 2
- Odisha South
- Tolly Jadavpur – Bihar

Delhi - North

- Ashoka
- Central Pitampura
- Delhi University
- Mansarover – Naraina
- Pusa
- Rajouri

North India

- Amritsar
- Chandigarh
- Jaipur Midtown
- Jammu
- Kanpur
- Lucknow

- Lucknow – Gorakhpur
- Madhya Pradesh
- Mansarovar
- Mohali
- Panchkula West
- Rajasthan North
- Vaishali

Delhi - South

- Alaknanda – GK 2
- Badkal – Faridabad
- CR Park – Kalkaji
- Charmwood
- Faridabad
- Green Park
- Hauz Khas
- Kailash

- New Friends Colony
- Sainik Farm
- Saket
- Sarita Vihar

South India

- Bangalore East
- Bangalore South
- Bangalore South Central
- Chennai Central
- Chennai East

Delhi - West

Aravali
DLF 1 & 3
DLF 2 & 4
Dwarka – Palam
Dwarka – Uttam Nagar
Epicentre
Golf Course
Janak Puri
Nirvana
Palam Vihar
SBTG
Shanti Path
Sohna
Vasant Kunj East
Vasant Kunj West
Vikasपुरi

West India - 1

Ahmedabad Central
Baner – Central
Goregaon Malad West
Kandivali East Dahisar
Koregaon – Airport
Magarpatta – Kharadi
Mulund Ghatkopar
PCMC – Aundh
Powai
Pune South 1
Pune South Hills
Surat
Thane – Kalyan

West India - 2

Bandra
Chembur – Ghatkopar
Gateway
Juhu Link – Yari Road
Juhu Vile Parle
Khar Santacruz BKC
Navi Mumbai
Sion Parel
Tardeo Malabar

MEETINGS IN OCTOBER 2025

5th October 2025

Cubs Division General Meeting



Region Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

26th October 2025

Discussion Meeting



District Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!



HAPPINESS COUNTER



Youth Division

1	4	2	2	8	3
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All India

2	8	8	5	4	0
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Q. How can we ensure every New Friend becomes a Member with care and compassion?

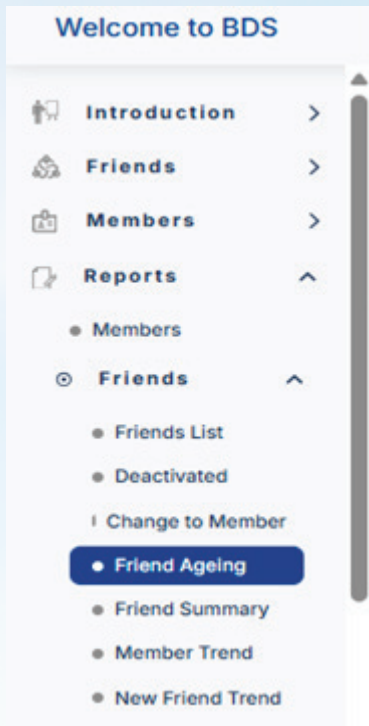
When a **New Friend** attends their first BSG meeting, they are added to the BDS as a **New Friend**. Once the attendance for that particular month is frozen, the New Friend becomes a **Friend**. Upon attending their **third BSG meeting** and getting their attendance marked for the third time in the BDS, the Friend becomes a **Member** automatically in the BDS.

To ensure this, it is important to cherish each New Friend, nurture them with constant care and help them learn about the faith and practice. This will encourage them to joyfully continue attending meetings.

At times, there are **Friends** who attend one or two meetings but do not attend the next one. It is vital that we reach out to them with compassion, extend a hand of trust and friendship and encourage them through their challenges. Ikeda Sensei says: **"The key to fostering capable individuals is encouragement. Without encouragement, it is often difficult for people to take a fresh step forward. Let's sincerely encourage each person, lift their spirits, and enable them to forge ahead with a bright, upbeat spirit"** (Humanology of Victory, p. 47-48)

With Sensei's guidance etched deep in our hearts, let us reach out to every new friend joining the practice and ensure they are personally cared for and encouraged. To facilitate this, the **Friends Ageing Report** available in BDS serves as a valuable tool for all **Deputy District Chiefs and above**. This report has the list of New **Friends** in our units.

How to access 'Friends Ageing Report'?

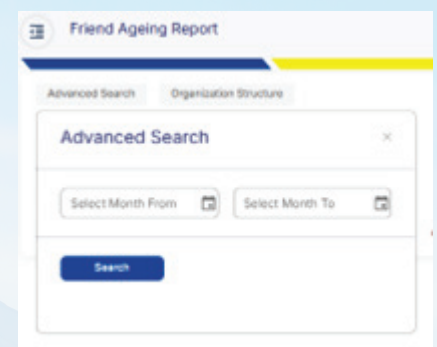


(A)

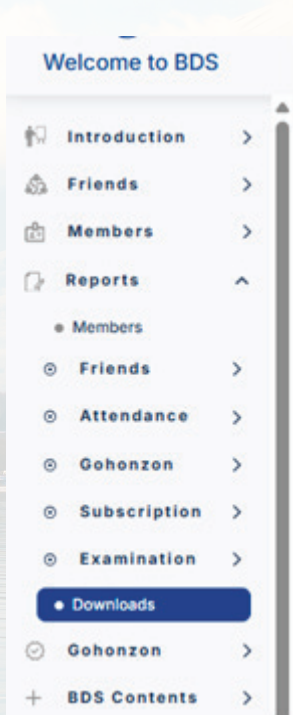
1. Login to BDS
2. Click on **Reports** followed by **Friends**
3. Now click on **Friends Ageing** (See the Image A)
4. We get two options – **Advanced Search** and **Organisation Structure** (See the Image B)
- 5 **Select the unit level** for which you would like to view the report.
- 6 **Choose the month/year range** and click **Search** (See the Image C)



(B)



(C)



(D)

7. The report will be displayed on the screen with the following fields – **Friend ID, Name, Division, Date of First Meeting, Total meetings attended, Last meeting, Introduced by, Introducer's mobile number and the organisation structure of the Friend.**

To download the report, click on – **Download Reports**

The report will appear the **Downloads** section in BDS. To save it to your device, simply go to **Downloads** and click **Download** against your report (See the Image D).

What is the use of Friends Ageing Report?

The Friends Ageing Report enables each unit to **review the details of the Friends who have joined the practice within a selected period.**

Accessing and reviewing this report every month during the **Discussion Planning**

Meeting can help districts identify and care for each friend without leaving anyone behind.

This simple yet powerful practice ensures that:

- Every new friend is encouraged consistently
- No one is left behind due to oversight
- Districts can monitor growth trends and follow-up opportunities
- Leaders can coordinate more meaningfully to foster new members

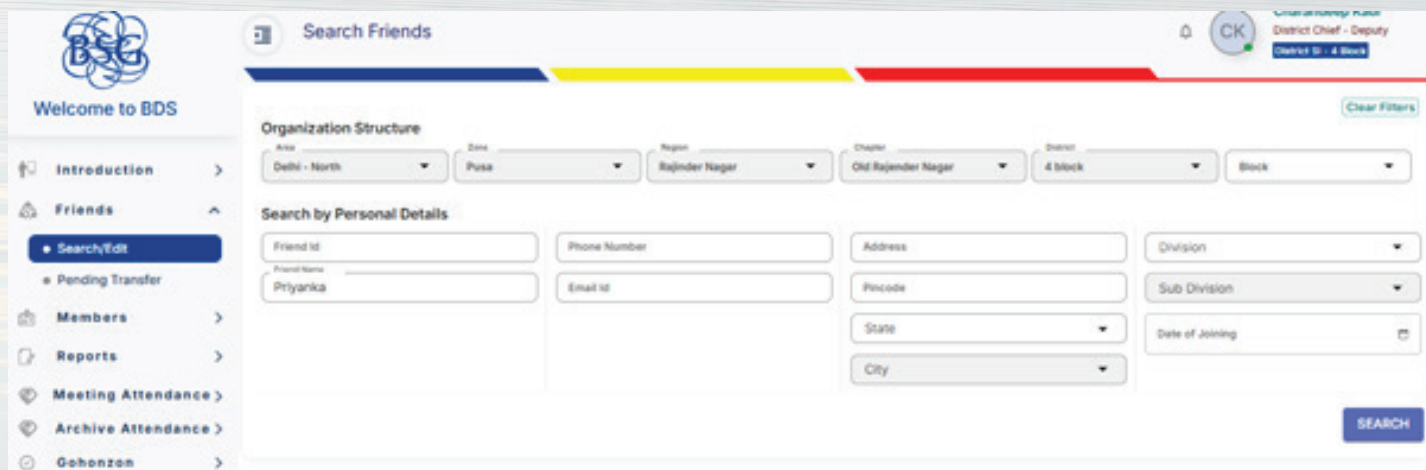
By making full use of this report, we can **build a stronger culture of Friend/Member care and follow-up**, ensuring that every new friend feels welcomed, supported, and inspired to continue their journey of faith.

Can we manually change a Friend to Member in BDS?

There are some **Friends** who show a keen interest in joining the practice and start chanting and learning Gongyo immediately after attending the first BSG meeting itself. In all such cases, **where Friends are ready to become members, districts have the option to manually make them members in BDS** without waiting for them to attend 3 BSG meetings. This **feature is available for District Statistics Incharges (DSI)**.

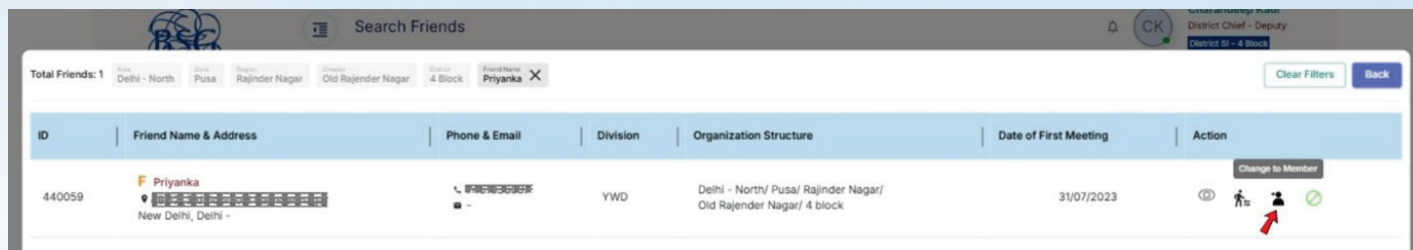
Let's see how to use it:

1. The DSI logs in to BDS
2. Click on **Friends**, then **Search/Edit**
3. Enter the **Friends's name** and **Search** (See the Image E)



(E)

4. The Friend's name shows up and under the **Action**, we can find the **Change to Member** option (See the Image F)



(F)

5. Click on **Change to Member**, a window opens with pre-filled details about the Friend. Crosscheck the details, assign the block and **Submit**. (See the Image G)

Welcome to BDS

Create New Member

Name Member Name: Priyanka

Address: New Delhi, Delhi -

State: Delhi City: New Delhi Pincode: 110001

Contact Number: 9876543210 Email Address: priyanka@gmail.com

Division: YWD Sub Division: Student Profession: India

Introducing's Name: Introducing's Contact Number: Introducing's Email Address:

Organization Structure

Area: Delhi - North Zone: Pusa Region: Rajinder Nagar Chapter: Old Rajender Nagar District: 4 Block Block: Block 1

Submit Cancel

(G)

By diligently using the BDS effectively, we can ensure that no one is left behind. Let us create districts where every New Friend and Friend is cherished, every Member is nurtured, and each life shines brightly toward 2030.



ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Mona Kinra

District Statistics Incharge, North India Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge?

My journey as a statistics incharge began at a time when there was no MDS or BDS system in place. I was entrusted with the responsibility of maintaining manual records — a task that seemed simple on the surface but gradually became a profound opportunity for my human revolution as a young women's division (YWD) member.

Being very young, I couldn't initially grasp the deeper significance of this role. But as I continued to

update members' details, reach out to them, and pray earnestly for each life, I gradually developed a deep sense of care, responsibility, and commitment. Each record became more than just a name on paper — it became a prayer, a connection, a vow.

Working closely with many seniors in faith, I received invaluable guidance and encouragement. One of the most transformative realizations I had was that genuine growth happens when we work together in unity across all divisions. This spirit of unity continues to guide my district's growth even today.



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

Being a statistics incharge has deeply shaped my daily life. It has taught me the importance of discipline, consistency, and doing each task with joy — no matter how small or routine it may seem.

These qualities began to influence not just my Gakkai activities, but also my personal and professional life. I became more responsive, more punctual, and more thoughtful in my interactions with others.

Today, I can truly feel the significance of being attentive and prompt. On days when I'm unable to open BDS due to family or work commitments, I feel something essential is missing — that unique happiness that comes from supporting and caring for each member with sincerity.



Please share your experience of working on BDS?

The introduction of BDS has been a game changer. It's incredibly user-friendly and has made all our efforts smoother and more efficient.

Whether it's introducing new members, processing transfers, applying for the Gohonzon, or marking attendance — everything can be done in just a few steps. This convenience allows us to spend less

time on technicalities and more time on what really matters: reaching out to members, supporting their faith, and advancing joyfully in unity.



Do you read the ABACUS regularly? What do you think is the importance of ABACUS personally for you?

I make it a point to read ABACUS regularly, and I find it not just useful, but deeply encouraging. Each issue feels like it has been compiled with so much care and love — from Sensei's guidance, the inspiring experiences of fellow statistics incharges and the other content.

What I enjoy the most is the puzzle section, which always reminds me to strengthen my practice of study. ABACUS fills me with a sense of renewed purpose and joy, and it encourages me to keep learning, growing, and sharing.



What is your determination as statistics incharge towards 2030?

- I will wholeheartedly encourage all members to read the monthly ABACUS editorial and draw inspiration from it.
- I will pray sincerely for each life in BDS to deeply connect with the Mystic Law and joyfully experience the Soka world.
- I will report a complete victory in health this year and continue to work, forever and ever, as a true emissary of the Buddha. ★★



Welcome to the ABACUS Puzzle Corner!



In this edition, we go beyond numbers — exploring how each calculation tell stories of **effort, accuracy, and growth**.



Each problem given below, celebrates the **joy of thinking, discovery, and getting it right**. So, take a deep breath, sharpen your mind, and enjoy the **mathematics of advancement**!

(Note: Values of 0.5 or more should be rounded up to the next whole number)

1. 20 members invited 5 new friends to the discussion meeting.

Question:

What is the total number of participants for the meeting?



Every new friend brings joy. Let's reach out and bring someone along next time!

2. In a chapter, for every 4 members attending a meeting, 1 new friend attends as a guest.

Question:

- a) If 84 members attended, how many new friends came?
- b) If the goal is to make the ratio 3:1 next month, how many new friends should join for the same number of members?

Raising the goal raises the spirit. Let us set clear targets for the discussion meeting.

3. 16 new friends were introduced in the May discussion meeting. While 10 attended the June discussion meeting, only 6 attended both June and July discussion meeting.

Question:

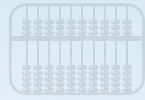
How many friends became members after marking the discussion meeting attendance for July?



Reaching out to our new friends is the key to building the network of friendship. Let's call and appreciate each new friend that shows up.

4. In February, there were 14 new friends. 70% of them attended March's meeting.

From those, only 5 attended and participated in the concept for the April discussion meeting.



Question:

How many friends attended both March and April discussion meeting?

Encouragement keeps connections alive. Let's wholeheartedly nurture our new friends and friends and include them in our Gakkai activities.

5. In April, a district had 18 new friends attending their discussion meeting.

Out of these, 2 new friends who were extremely seeking and wanted to make a contribution in May, were manually made members by the district statistics incharge. And 5 new friends from the remaining attended the May and June discussion meeting?

Question:

How many friends from 18 have become members by the end of June?

When someone's seeking and ready, let's help them grow. Friends can be manually added as members from the district statistics login.

6. A district had a membership of 100 members till September.

Upon rechecking, they realized 10% were duplicate entries and 5% had relocated abroad which were then deactivated by Helpdesk.

Question:

What is the current membership of the district?

Accuracy is compassion in action. Let's review and update our BDS records.

7. Last month, 4 districts in a chapter had the following number of new friends joined the practice:

- Hope – 18
- Joy – 12
- Courage – 9
- Faith – 15



Question:

a) How many new friends joined in total?

b) If each district aims to increase their new friends target by 20% next month,

what will be the new friends target of the chapter?

Set a shared target and unite hearts - when goals are clear, victories multiply!

8. In September, 8 districts in a region held discussion meetings.

Average attendance per meeting was 42.



Amongst these districts, 1 district named 'Victory' also held a weekday discussion meeting in addition and their attendance got jumped by 50%.

Question:

- a) What was the final attendance of the Victory district?
- b) What was the total attendance for all 8 districts combined?

A weekday meeting in addition to the discussion meeting is a great way to include those who couldn't attend the discussion meeting. Let's help everyone feel the joy of discussion meetings.

9. Three chapters in a region - A, B, and C, held a total of 12 meetings this month.

- a) Chapter A held 5 meetings with an average attendance of 36.
- b) Chapter B held 4 meetings with an average attendance of 42.
- c) Chapter C held 3 meetings with an average attendance of 54.



Question:

- a) What was the total attendance across all meetings?
- b) What was the overall average attendance per meeting for all three chapters combined?

Use the monthly trends as your guide. Let us review, reflect, and act to strengthen our units.

10. One member attended the discussion meeting in January 2025.

That member introduced 3 new friends in February.

Each of these new friends introduced 2 new friends in March.

In April, only 80% of the new friends introduced in March remained active and each of them introduced 2 new friends in May.



Question:

- In the month of May 2025, how many new friends were introduced?
- How many total new friends have been introduced so far in this year?

One person's determination can inspire many. Let us hold dialogues with as many people as possible.

Please send your answers at statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org by 31st October 2025

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

- | | |
|------------------|--------------|
| 1. Seed | 6. Citadel |
| 2. Opportunities | 7. Humanity |
| 3. Strong | 8. Victories |
| 4. Treasures | 9. Joy |
| 5. Grow | 10. Benefit |

LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE WINNERS

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ★ Archana M N – South India | ★ Sonia Jhington – West India 1 |
| ★ Kareshma Khanna – North India | ★ Varsha – Delhi South |
| ★ Richa Jain – West India 1 | ★ Vartika Agrawal – North India |
| ★ Shobha Dube – Delhi North | |



BDS HELPDESK

In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to: helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.

WE WANT YOUR FEEDBACK

We look forward to hearing from you! Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at : statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org

